millions of dollars' worth of food to feed the people of Poland. We were striking a delicate balance.

Almost as soon as I moved into the White House, we began informing Moscow that military intervention by the Soviets in Poland would be resisted by us through every diplomatic means at our disposal. In late spring, after intelligence reports indicated that the Soviets were contemplating an invasion of Poland, I wrote to Brezhnev that the United States and the rest of the Western world would look very unfavorably on such an attack; I said the Soviets could forget any new nuclear arms agreements or better trade relations with us and expect the harshest possible economic sanctions from the United States if they launched an invasion. Brezhnev replied that what was going on in Poland was an internal matter for Poland's puppet government alone to deal with, and the Soviet Union had no interest in the United States attitude about Poland.

After our initial correspondence following my release from the hospital in April, Brezhnev and I had exchanged several other chilly letters in which we expressed an interest in continuing a dialogue between the two of us. But he always refused to abandon the Brezhnev Doctrine (although he didn't call it that), and I kept telling him there was no hope of improving our relations until the Soviet Union stopped pushing its policy of expansionism and trying to subvert democratic governments. As I concluded one letter, "In sum, the United States is more interested in actions which further the cause of world peace than in words."

Poland's brave shipyard workers continued their fight for freedom throughout the fall of 1981, triggering persistent rumors and intelligence reports that the Soviets were considering an invasion, along with continued expressions of our opposition to this possibility. On Sunday, December 13, Poland—and Moscow—finallyacted. Without warning, the Polish military government closed the country's borders,